

NTANDOMODS ICT DIPLOMA

MONTH 4

Microsoft PowerPoint

Presentations, Slides & Visual Communication

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Introduction to PowerPoint

Microsoft PowerPoint is used to create presentations - slides that are shown on a screen while you talk to an audience. Presentations are used in meetings, training sessions, classrooms, and business pitches.

Whether you are presenting a new product to your boss, training staff on till procedures, or pitching your business idea, PowerPoint is the tool you need.

Learning Outcomes

- Create a new presentation with multiple slides
- Use different slide layouts (title, content, blank, comparison)
- Add text, images, shapes, and icons to slides
- Apply themes, colours, and consistent design
- Add transitions and animations
- Use speaker notes
- Present using Slideshow mode
- Export presentations as PDF

Unit 1: Getting Started

1.1 Opening PowerPoint

1. Start menu > search 'PowerPoint' > click to open

2. Select 'Blank Presentation' or choose a template

1.2 The PowerPoint Interface

Element	Purpose
Slide Panel (left)	Shows thumbnails of all your slides
Main Slide Area (centre)	Where you edit the current slide
Ribbon (top)	Tabs: Home, Insert, Design, Transitions, Animations, Slideshow
Notes Panel (bottom)	Write speaker notes that only you can see during presentation
Status Bar	Slide number, view options, zoom

1.3 Slide Layouts

- Title Slide - for the first slide (presentation title and your name)
- Title and Content - most common layout (heading + bullet points)
- Two Content - split layout for comparison
- Blank - for custom designs with images
- Section Header - to separate major topics

1.4 Adding New Slides

1. Click Home tab > New Slide
2. Choose the layout you want
3. Or right-click in the slide panel > New Slide

Unit 2: Design Principles

2.1 The 5 Rules of Good Presentations

1. Keep it simple - one idea per slide, maximum 6 bullet points
2. Use large text - minimum 24pt for body text, 36pt+ for titles
3. Use high-quality images - blurry photos look unprofessional

4. Be consistent - same fonts, colours, and style throughout
5. Less is more - do not put everything on the slide; you are the speaker, not the slide

2.2 Applying Themes

1. Go to Design tab
2. Browse the built-in themes
3. Click one to apply it to all slides
4. Use Variants (right side) to change colour schemes

2.3 Colour Tips

- Use dark text on a light background (easiest to read)
- Limit to 3 colours maximum: primary, secondary, and accent
- Never use red and green together (colour-blind people cannot distinguish them)
- Use high contrast - light grey text on white is invisible from the back of a room

2.4 Fonts

- Use sans-serif fonts for presentations: Arial, Calibri, Verdana
- Never use more than 2 fonts in one presentation
- Title font can be bold/larger, body font should be clean and simple

Unit 3: Adding Content

3.1 Text

- Click on a text placeholder and start typing
- Use bullet points for lists (keep each point short - 1 line maximum)
- Never write full paragraphs on a slide - that is what your speech is for

3.2 Images

1. Insert tab > Pictures > This Device (or Online Pictures)
2. Select and insert
3. Resize using corner handles (hold Shift to keep proportions)
4. Use Picture Format tab to crop, add borders, or adjust brightness

3.3 Shapes and Icons

1. Insert tab > Shapes (rectangles, arrows, circles, speech bubbles)
2. Insert tab > Icons (professional icons for business, technology, etc.)
3. Use shapes to create diagrams, processes, and timelines

3.4 Tables and Charts

- Insert tab > Table - for structured data
- Insert tab > Chart - for visual data (same as Excel charts)
- Keep tables simple - 3-4 columns maximum on a slide

Unit 4: Transitions, Animations & Presenting

4.1 Transitions

Transitions are the visual effects when moving from one slide to the next.

1. Click on a slide in the slide panel
2. Go to Transitions tab
3. Choose a transition (Fade and Push are professional; Fly and Spin are not)
4. Set Duration (0.5 to 1 second is best)
5. Click 'Apply to All' for consistency

WARNING: Never use more than one type of transition in a professional presentation. Pick one and stick with it.

4.2 Animations

Animations make individual elements appear, move, or disappear on a slide.

- Entrance animations: elements appear (Fade In, Appear)
- Exit animations: elements disappear (Fade Out)
- Use sparingly - one or two per slide maximum
- Never use bouncing, spinning, or flashy animations in a professional setting

4.3 Speaker Notes

Speaker notes are your personal script. The audience cannot see them - only you can, on your laptop screen while presenting.

1. Click in the Notes panel at the bottom of the screen
2. Type your key points and reminders
3. During presentation, use Presenter View to see notes on your screen

4.4 Presenting Your Slideshow

1. Press F5 to start from the beginning (or Shift + F5 for current slide)
2. Click or press the spacebar/arrow keys to move to the next slide
3. Press Escape to exit slideshow mode
4. Use Presenter View: Slideshow tab > Use Presenter View

4.5 Exporting as PDF

1. File > Save As (or Export)
2. Change file type to PDF
3. Click Save

PDFs are useful for sending presentations to people who do not have PowerPoint.

Month 4 Assessment

Theory (30 marks)

1. List 5 rules of a good presentation. (10 marks)
2. What is the difference between a transition and an animation? (4 marks)
3. Name 3 slide layouts and when you would use each one. (6 marks)
4. What are speaker notes and why are they useful? (4 marks)
5. What font size should body text be in a presentation? Why? (6 marks)

Practical (70 marks)

1. Create a 10-slide presentation about a topic of your choice (e.g. 'How to Start a Business in Zimbabwe' or 'The Importance of ICT Skills'). Must include: title slide, contents slide, images, a table or chart, transitions, and speaker notes on every slide. (50 marks)
2. Present your slideshow to the class for 5 minutes using Presenter View. (20 marks)

Pass Mark: 60%